

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 582

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Minister Michaela Anne Byers of Shelby County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Minister Michaela Anne Byers; and

WHEREAS, Minister Michaela Byers was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, a longtime resident of Shelby County, Minister Byers was a highly respected member of the Eads and Memphis communities; and

WHEREAS, born on November 30, 1949, she was one of sixteen children born to Rance T. and Lorse L. Johnson and raised in a home deeply rooted in faith, family, and service; and

WHEREAS, under the guidance of the late Bishop Gary Hunt, Minister Byers accepted Jesus Christ as her Lord and Savior, was baptized, and guided to ministry through her service at Apostolic Faith Temple; and

WHEREAS, in 1982, Minister Michaela Byers was ordained by the Pentecostal Assemblies of the World, Inc., and she later became an active and devout member of the Faith Christian Church, which she served faithfully for many years, working in the youth ministry and teaching Sunday School and Bible Study; and

WHEREAS, when delivering the Word on Sundays, Minister Byers allowed God to speak through her with joy and creativity, and she often used visual aids, props, and expressive demonstrations to bring Scripture to life to ensure everyone, young and old, could clearly understand the message; and

WHEREAS, Minister Michael Byers was a 1967 graduate of Carver High School; she continued her education by becoming a licensed cosmetologist through Suzanne's Business College in Los Angeles, California, and attending Southwest Tennessee Community College; and

WHEREAS, Minister Byers served with acumen and alacrity for thirty-two years with the Shelby County Sheriff's Department and retired as Captain in 2022, in which position she earned the respect of her colleagues and community alike for the superior quality of her work; and

WHEREAS, known for her elegance, unmistakable sense of style, and signature brooches, Michael Byers was a deeply generous woman who gave her time, resources, and love without hesitation, and she shared her love of God with a radiant spirit that inspired all who encountered her; and

WHEREAS, she was also deeply devoted to her family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Minister Byers is survived by her children, L. Angela (Amber) Webb, Robert L. Coles, Jr., Micah J. (Marshae) Lyons, Royale K. Lyons, and Darrold Lyons; eight grandchildren, Micheale Currin, Jamie Currin, Pirsia Coles, Macai Lyons, Illias Lyons, Sabirah Lyons, Carlyn Lyons, and Darrold Lyons, Jr.; siblings, Michael Andrew Johnson, Royale Johnson, Bishop Eugene (Carolyn) Johnson, Mary Wilson, E'thel Tillis, and Hester Moore; and a host of nieces, nephews, church family, and friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her parents, she was preceded in death by her siblings, Alfred Johnson, Jerry Johnson, Sr., Ollie Johnson, Tommie Butler, Pinkie "Sharp" Johnson, and Peggy Copeland; and

WHEREAS, Minister Michaela Byers leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Minister Michaela Anne Byers, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Minister Byers.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.